

fyng or deleting. The path has to be enclosed in square brackets, and each sub-key level is separated by a backslash. For example: [HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\International]. If the sub-key in the path does not exist, it will be created—hence it is important that you follow the correct order in specifying the path. For example, if you erroneously create the path as [HKEY_CURRENT_USER\International\Control Panel], then a new key called International will be created under HKEY_CURRENT_USER with a sub-key called Control Panel. Multiple entries in the .reg file will each start with their own paths separated by blank lines.

The "DataItemName1"="DataType1:DataValue1" determines the specific values of the key (or sub-key). Each key can have one or more DataItemName. This is the specified name of the data, and is enclosed in quotation marks. It is immediately followed by an equals sign. To the right of the equals sign, the data type (DWORD or hexadecimal) is specified, followed by the actual data. If the data is of the String type, then no data type is specified, and the Registry will understand that the data type is String. The data type and the data value are separated by colons, and the entire entry is enclosed in quotations. Here's an example.

```
[HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Appearance]
"Current"="Windows 2000"
"PreviewMode"=hex:04,00,00,00
"ShowNewProcesses"=dword:00000000
```

Here, the data name **Current** has a string value: "Windows 2000". The data name **PreviewMode** has a binary value represented in hexadecimal. The data name **ShowNewProcesses** has a DWORD value of 00000000.

If the data name does not exist it will be created in the sub-key specified in the path; if it exists, it will overwrite the existing value with the new values. If you want to delete entries in the Registry with a .reg file, you can use the hyphen symbol. For example, [-HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Control Panel\Test] will delete the